

OnePlus Buds 3

Well-rounded sound, excellent fit, and robust features all in a sleek package

OnePlus was introduced to us as a brand that was out there to be a flagship killer.

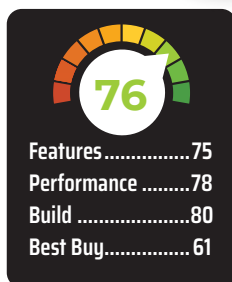
Over the years, the brand has evidently shifted away from that philosophy for the most part. However, the remnants of the flagship killer brand still remain to be seen in the products that they release to this day. On the smartphone side of things, the biggest example of this was the OnePlus Open. When it comes to audio, their latest OnePlus Buds 3 come close to being what I would call a pair that is ready to take on earbuds that are priced almost twice as much as this offering which comes in at Rs 5,499.

These buds launched alongside OnePlus' latest line of phones, the OnePlus 12 and the 12R.

The OnePlus Buds 3, come with all the creature comforts that you could ask for fitted in a package that has made a name for itself over time with the OnePlus Buds Pro 2. I have a lot to say about the OnePlus Buds 3. Spoiler Alert - They are mostly positive. So, without much delay, let's have a look at the detailed review of the OnePlus Buds 3.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Right off the bat, the OnePlus Buds 3 won my heart, with their likeness to the OnePlus Buds Pro 2. The charging case of the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 and their fit is my personal favourite amongst all the earbuds, being trumped by the Nothing Ear (2) and the Apple AirPods Pro 2nd Generation. All three earbuds have a stem design, and I was elated to see that design being implemented in the OnePlus Buds 3. You get a matte finish on the case with two colour options to choose from - Splendid Blue



and Metallic Gray. The buds have a dual texture finish with the outer side of the buds having a glossy finish and the inside having a matte finish.

The materials used on both the case and the buds are at par, if not better than what we see with

earbuds in this price range. There is no metallic hinge on the case, but it feels robust. The magnets holding the lid and the buds are strong and do not let them loose. As for the fit of the buds, as I prefaced earlier, for me, it worked wonders. There was minimal leakage of sound even at the highest volume levels and it also ensured that I got great passive isolation, which in turn helped the effectiveness of the ANC.

I went out for a few runs with these earbuds on and I never felt uneasy wearing them, and neither did they feel that they would slip out of my ear because of the vibrations. I passed the earbuds around the folks at the Digit Test Centre and the response to the fit of the buds was great. You get a total of three pairs of silicone eartips in the box,

which you can switch to ensure that you get a great fit as well.

But, again, as it is with all things audio, the fit is very subjective and what fit well for us, might not be for you. So, I would recommend that you try these out before getting your hands on them. The case is also pocketable and shaped like a flat puck, ensuring that it does not bulge out of your pocket a lot. Taking it in and out of the pocket is also fairly easy.

FEATURES

In terms of the features, OnePlus has made sure that you have all your basics covered. First off, you get support for LHDC high-res CODEC which ensures that your music will sound crisp at all times. The controls on the buds are solid and well-implemented. You get volume controls on the buds which makes for a great addition to the basic controls. Then there is our favourite, Hey Melody app. You get ample control and customisation options on the buds, letting you, truly make them your own. There, you also get the option to personalise your listening experience further with the OnePlus Audio ID 2.0. When I did the test runs to figure out the difference between the out of box experience and the personalised audio experience, I did find a few changes made to the low-frequency response. However, it was for the worse in my case and as per my taste. Your mileage may vary. Again, everything in the world of audio is very subjective. So, try it out on your own before buying.

You also have the Spatial Audio equivalent on these buds, in the form of OnePlus 3D Audio. It does a great job of providing an immersive experience, and I found it especially useful to level up my gaming and movie-watching experience. Talking about gaming, you get a 94 ms low latency mode. It is not the most impressive of the lot, but does the job of making the experience snappier. There is ANC as well, which I will be talking about in the next section of this review. There is Google Fast Pair baked into the buds to ensure quick pairing to Android devices. Even on my iPhone